

Absolute Value Equations and Inequalities

Absolute Value

Example I) $|3| = \boxed{3}$

Example II) $|-5| = \boxed{5}$

Example III) $|36| = \boxed{36}$

Example IV) $|-1047| = \boxed{1047}$

Absolute Value Equations

Solve.

① $|x| = 8$

$x = 8$ or $x = -8$

② $|y| = 3$

$y = 3$ or $y = -3$

③ $|b| + 3 = 7$

$|b| = 4$

$b = 4$ or $b = -4$

④ $10 = |x| - 2$

$12 = |x|$

$12 = x$ or $-12 = x$

⑤ $\frac{|y|}{4} = 2$

$|y| = 8$

$y = 8$ or $y = -8$

⑦ $9 = 2|x|$

$\frac{9}{2} = |x|$

$\frac{9}{2} = x$ or $-\frac{9}{2} = x$

⑨ $3|x| - 7 = 4$

$7 + 3|x| - 7 = 4 + 7$

$3|x| = 11$

$\frac{3|x|}{3} = \frac{11}{3}$

$|x| = \frac{11}{3}$

$x = \frac{11}{3}$ or $x = -\frac{11}{3}$

⑥ $-2 = \frac{|b|}{-5}$

$10 = |b|$

$10 = b$ or $-10 = b$

⑧ $5|y| = 10$

$|y| = 2$

$y = 2$ or $y = -2$

⑩ $15 = 3 + \frac{|y|}{2}$

$24 = |y|$

$24 = y$ or $-24 = y$

$$\textcircled{11} 7 = 2|b| + 5$$

$$1 = |b|$$

$$b = 1 \text{ or } b = -1$$

$$\textcircled{12} \frac{|x|}{3} - 8 = 1$$

$$|x| = 27$$

$$x = 27 \text{ or } x = -27$$

$$\textcircled{13} -6 = 1 - \frac{|b|}{3}$$

$$-6 = 1 + \frac{|b|}{-3}$$

$$-7 = \frac{|b|}{-3}$$

$$21 = |b|$$

$$21 = b \text{ or } -21 = b$$

$$\textcircled{14} 0 = 2 - |x|$$

$$-2 + 0 = 2 - |x| - 2$$

$$-2 = -|x|$$

$$\underline{-2} = \underline{(-1)} \underline{|x|}$$

$$2 = |x|$$

$$x = 2 \text{ or } x = -2$$

$$\textcircled{15} 7 - |b| = 4$$

$$-|b| = -3$$

$$(-1)|b| = -3$$

$$|b| = 3$$

$$b = 3 \text{ or } b = -3$$

$$\textcircled{16} 4 - 2|y| = 3$$

$$-2|y| = -1$$

$$|y| = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$y = \frac{1}{2} \text{ or } y = -\frac{1}{2}$$

$$\star \textcircled{17} |y| + 2 = -3$$

$$|y| = -5$$

No Solution

$$\star \textcircled{18} 4 = \frac{|b|}{-3}$$

$$-12 = |b|$$

No Solution

$$\textcircled{19} |x+2| = 7$$

$$x+2 = 7 \text{ or } x+2 = -7$$

$$x = 5 \text{ or } x = -9$$

$$\textcircled{20} 4 = |3y|$$

$$4 = 3y \text{ or } -4 = 3y$$

$$\frac{4}{3} = y \text{ or } -\frac{4}{3} = y$$

$$\textcircled{21} 2 = |-3+b|$$

$$2 = -3+b \text{ or } -2 = -3+b$$

$$5 = b \text{ or } 1 = b$$

$$\textcircled{22} \left| \frac{x}{-3} \right| = 10$$

$$\frac{x}{-3} = 10 \text{ or } \frac{x}{-3} = -10$$

$$x = -30 \text{ or } x = 30$$

$$\textcircled{23} 3|5x-2|+4=10$$

$$-4 + 3|5x-2|+4=10-4$$

$$3|5x-2|=6$$

$$\underline{3|5x-2|=6}$$

$$|5x-2|=2$$

$$5x-2=2 \text{ or } 5x-2=-2$$

$$\boxed{x=\frac{4}{5} \text{ or } x=0}$$

$$\star \textcircled{25} \frac{|\frac{b}{3}-4|}{2}-5=-5$$

$$5+\frac{|\frac{b}{3}-4|}{2}-5=-5+5$$

$$\frac{|\frac{b}{3}-4|}{2}=0$$

$$(2) \frac{|\frac{b}{3}-4|}{2}=0(2)$$

$$|\frac{b}{3}-4|=0$$

$$\frac{b}{3}-4=0$$

$$\boxed{b=12}$$

$$\textcircled{24} 22=6|\frac{y}{5}+3|-2$$

$$4=|\frac{y}{5}+3|$$

$$4=\frac{y}{5}+3 \text{ or } -4=\frac{y}{5}+3$$

$$\boxed{5=y \text{ or } -35=y}$$

$$\textcircled{26} 4|3+2x|-8=4$$

$$|3+2x|=3$$

$$3+2x=3 \text{ or } 3+2x=-3$$

$$\boxed{x=0 \text{ or } x=-3}$$

$$\textcircled{27} -5=\frac{|8b-1|}{-4}-3$$

$$8=|8b-1|$$

$$8=8b-1 \text{ or } -8=8b-1$$

$$\boxed{\frac{9}{8}=b \text{ or } -\frac{7}{8}=b}$$

$$\textcircled{28} 8=6+\frac{|2-4y|}{5}$$

$$10=|2-4y|$$

$$10=2-4y \text{ or } -10=2-4y$$

$$\boxed{-2=y \text{ or } 3=y}$$

$$\star \textcircled{29} -5|\frac{x}{6}+7|+14=14$$

$$|\frac{x}{6}+7|=0$$

$$\frac{x}{6}+7=0$$

$$\boxed{x=-42}$$

$$\textcircled{30} 16=8+\frac{|\frac{y}{2}-3|}{5}$$

$$40=|\frac{y}{2}-3|$$

$$40=\frac{y}{2}-3 \text{ or } -40=\frac{y}{2}-3$$

$$\boxed{-86=y \text{ or } 74=y}$$

(31) $-7|1-4x|+8=5$
 $|1-4x| = \frac{3}{7}$
 $1-4x = \frac{3}{7}$ or $1-4x = -\frac{3}{7}$
 $-4x = -\frac{4}{7}$ or $-4x = -\frac{10}{7}$
 $x = \frac{1}{7}$ or $x = \frac{5}{14}$

(32) $-9|\frac{y}{5}+6|-8=-12$
 $|\frac{y}{5}+6| = \frac{4}{9}$
 $\frac{y}{5}+6 = \frac{4}{9}$ or $\frac{y}{5}+6 = -\frac{4}{9}$
 $\frac{y}{5} = -\frac{50}{9}$ or $\frac{y}{5} = -\frac{58}{9}$
 $y = -\frac{250}{9}$ or $y = -\frac{290}{9}$

(33) $8 = -5 + \frac{3|y-1|}{2}$
 $5+8 = -5 + \frac{3|y-1|}{2} + 5$
 $13 = \frac{3|y-1|}{2}$
 $(2) 13 = \frac{3|y-1|}{2} (2)$
 $26 = 3|y-1|$
 $\frac{26}{3} = \frac{3|y-1|}{3}$
 $\frac{26}{3} = |y-1|$
 $y-1 = \frac{26}{3}$ or $y-1 = -\frac{26}{3}$
 $y = \frac{29}{3}$ or $y = -\frac{23}{3}$

(34) $\frac{5|x+2|}{3} + 4 = 6$
 $5|x+2| = 6$
 $|x+2| = \frac{6}{5}$
 $x+2 = \frac{6}{5}$ or $x+2 = -\frac{6}{5}$
 $x = -\frac{4}{5}$ or $x = -\frac{16}{5}$

Absolute Value Inequalities (also called compound inequalities)

Find the algebraic solutions and the graphical solutions of the following inequalities.

(35) $|x| > 2$

$x < -2$ or $x > 2$

(36) $7 \geq |y|$

$y \geq -7$ and $y \leq 7$

(37) $|b| \leq 4$

$b \geq -4$ and $b \leq 4$

(38) $8 < |x|$

$x < -8$ or $x > 8$

(39) $|y| > -7$

y can be any real number.

(40) $-3 > |x|$

No solution

④① $|b| > 0$

b can be any real number except zero.



④② $0 \geq |y|$

$y = 0$



④③ $0 > |x|$

No solutions

④④ $|y| \geq 0$

y can be any real number.

④⑤ $|b| \leq 0$

$b = 0$



④⑥ $|x| < -1$

No solutions

The Absolute Value Inequality Theorems

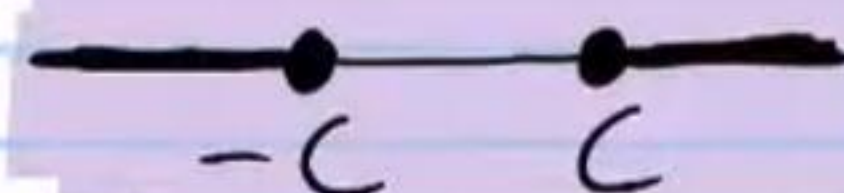
In the following inequalities, C is a nonnegative constant.

I) If $|x| \geq C$, then

Algebraic Solution

$x \leq -C$ or $x \geq C$

Graphical Solution



II) If $|x| \leq C$, then

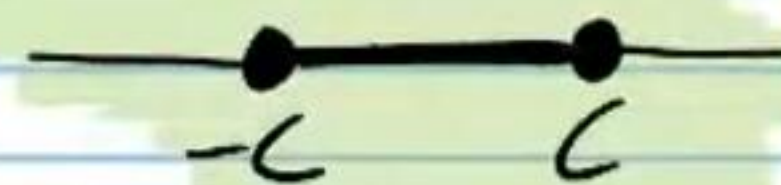
Algebraic Solution

$x \leq C$ and $x \geq -C$

also acceptable

$-C \leq x \leq C$

Graphical Solution



* If $<$ or $>$ signs appear, then open circles must be used (e.g. $\text{---} \circ \text{---}$ or $\text{---} \circ \circ \text{---}$).

III) If $|x| < -C$, then there are no solutions.

IV) If $|x| \leq 0$, then $x = 0$ only.

V) If $|x| \geq -C$, then x can be any real number.

VI) If $|x| > 0$, then x can be any real number except zero.

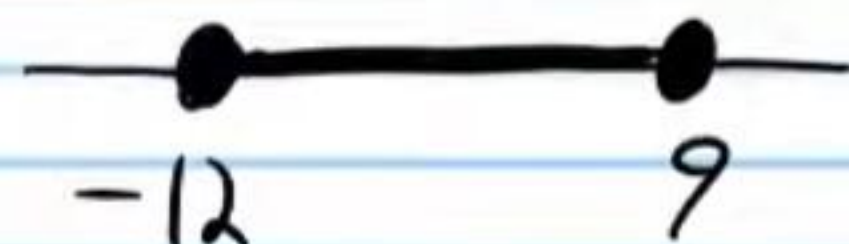
$$(47) 5 \geq \frac{|-2b-3|}{7} + 2$$

$$21 \geq |-2b-3|$$

$$-2b-3 \leq 21 \text{ and } -2b-3 \geq -21$$

$$-2b \leq 24 \text{ and } -2b \geq -18$$

$$b \geq -12 \text{ and } b \leq 9$$



$$(48) 5|-2+6y|-8 > 2$$

$$|-2+6y| > 2$$

$$-2+6y > 2 \text{ or } -2+6y < -2$$

$$y > \frac{2}{3} \text{ or } y < 0$$



$$(49) 2|\frac{x}{5}+6|+3 \leq 7$$

$$|\frac{x}{5}+6| \leq 2$$

$$\frac{x}{5}+6 \geq -2 \text{ and } \frac{x}{5}+6 \leq 2$$

$$x \leq 40 \text{ and } x \geq 20$$

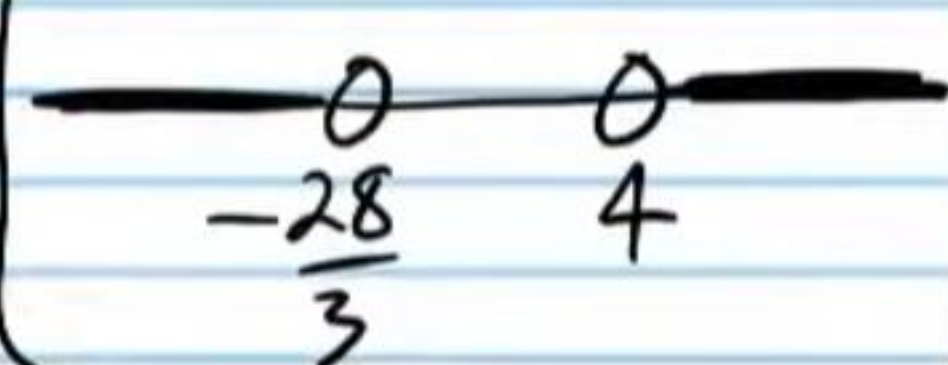


$$(50) 2 < -3 + \frac{|8+3y|}{4}$$

$$20 < |8+3y|$$

$$8+3y > 20 \text{ or } 8+3y < -20$$

$$y > 4 \text{ or } y < -\frac{28}{3}$$



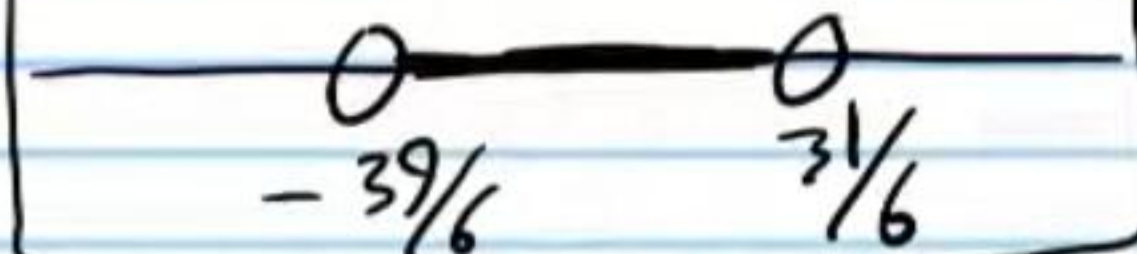
$$(51) -5 < 2 + \frac{|4+6y|}{-5}$$

$$-7 < \frac{|4+6y|}{-5}$$

$$35 > |4+6y|$$

$$4+6y > -35 \text{ and } 4+6y < 35$$

$$y > -\frac{39}{6} \text{ and } y < \frac{31}{6}$$



$$(52) -4|\frac{b}{6}-2|+8 \leq 7$$

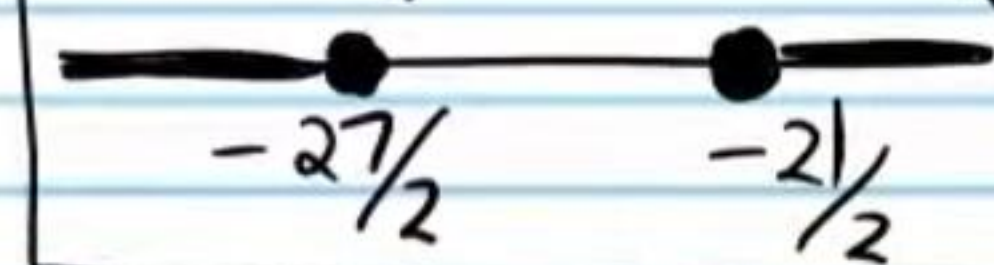
$$-4|\frac{b}{6}-2| \leq -1$$

$$|\frac{b}{6}-2| \geq \frac{1}{4}$$

$$\frac{b}{6}-2 \geq \frac{1}{4} \text{ or } \frac{b}{6}-2 \leq -\frac{1}{4}$$

$$\frac{b}{6} \geq \frac{9}{4} \text{ or } \frac{b}{6} \leq \frac{7}{4}$$

$$b \leq -\frac{27}{2} \text{ or } b \geq -\frac{21}{2}$$

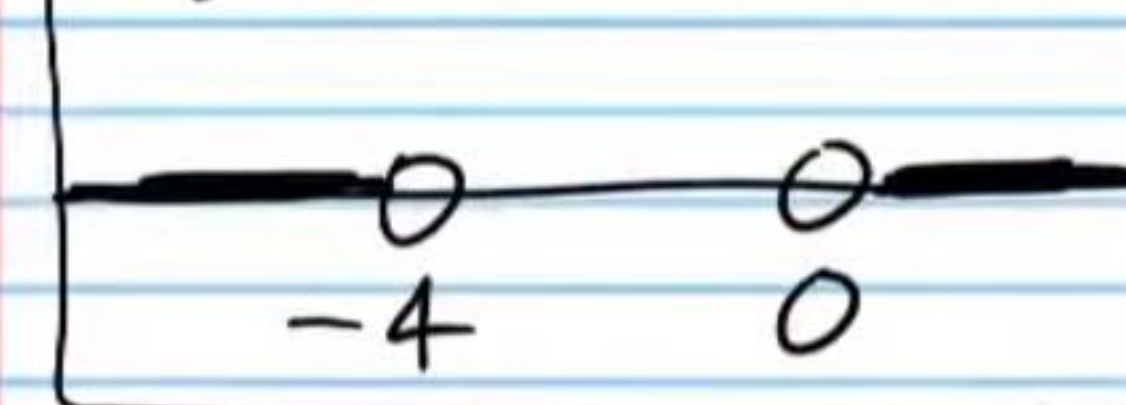


$$(53) -44 > -8|6+3b|+4$$

$$6 < |6+3b|$$

$$6+3b > 6 \text{ or } 6+3b < -6$$

$$b > 0 \text{ or } b < -4$$



$$(54) \frac{3|2-5x|}{-4} + 6 < -1$$

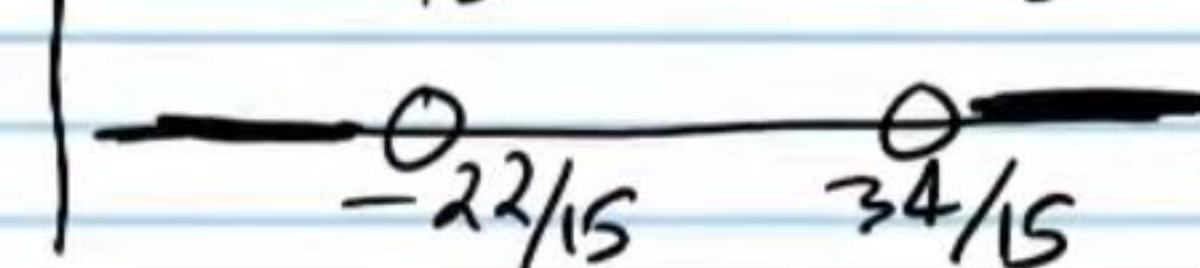
$$3|2-5x| > 28$$

$$|2-5x| > \frac{28}{3}$$

$$2-5x > \frac{28}{3} \text{ or } 2-5x < -\frac{28}{3}$$

$$-5x > \frac{22}{3} \text{ or } -5x < -\frac{34}{3}$$

$$x < -\frac{22}{15} \text{ or } x > \frac{34}{15}$$



$$\textcircled{55} \frac{|\frac{b}{3}+4|}{-8} - 10 \leq -9$$

$$|\frac{b}{3}+4| \geq -8$$

$\frac{b}{3}+4$ can be any real number, which means that b can be any real number.

$$\textcircled{57} -2 \leq -7|\frac{y}{-5}+1| - 2$$

$$0 \leq -7|\frac{y}{-5}+1|$$

$$0 \geq |\frac{y}{-5}+1|$$

$$\frac{y}{-5}+1=0$$

$$\boxed{y=5}$$



$$\textcircled{56} 8 \leq 6 - |8b-3|$$

$$2 \leq -|8b-3|$$

$$2 \leq (-1)|8b-3|$$

$$-2 \geq |8b-3|$$

There is no number that $8b-3$ can be that will work in the inequality, which means there is no value of b that will work either.

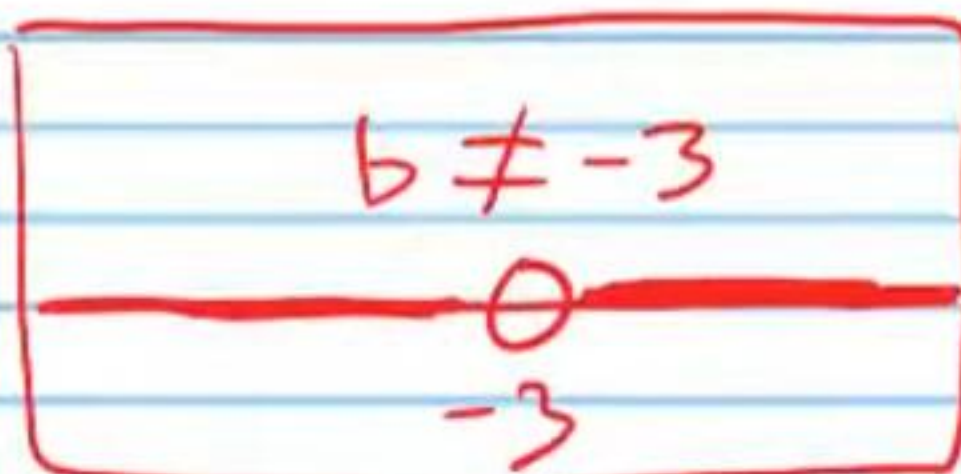
$$\textcircled{58} -1 + \frac{|b+3|}{-2} < -1$$

$$\frac{|b+3|}{-2} < 0$$

$$|b+3| > 0$$

$$b+3 \neq 0$$

$$b \neq -3$$



$$\textcircled{59} \frac{|5x+2|}{3} + 4 < 4$$

$$|5x+2| < 0$$

No solutions

$$\textcircled{60} -2|3-7y| + 7 \geq 7$$

$$|3-7y| \leq 0$$

$$3-7y=0$$

$$\boxed{y=\frac{3}{7}}$$



$$\textcircled{61} -2|3x-1| + 4 < 16$$

$$|3x-1| > -6$$

x can be any real number.

$$\textcircled{62} 8 < \frac{|\frac{y}{2}+5|}{4} + 8$$

$$0 < |\frac{y}{2}+5|$$

$$\frac{y}{2}+5 \neq 0$$

$$y \neq -10$$

